

Drawing the Line

The scope statement gets real

Kurosawa Digital, meeting room B. 7:40 PM. The office is nearly empty. Ren has printed his draft scope statement; Saki has already covered it in red pen. Director Kudo's assistant has just forwarded yet another feature request via email.

Ren (蓮) "Okay, I wrote up what's in and what's out. It's all here — one page, nice and clean."

Saki (咲希) "Your **scope statement** (a detailed description of the project scope including **deliverables** and boundaries) is missing exclusions, acceptance criteria, and constraints. That's not a scope statement — it's a wish list."

→ A *scope statement* formally documents what the project will and won't deliver. Without explicit boundaries, any request can be argued as "in scope."

Ren (蓮) "Fine, fine. But before you redline everything — can we at least agree on the big pieces? Like, the XR demo module, the content pipeline, the analytics dashboard. Those are the **work packages** (the lowest-level tasks we can actually assign and track)."

→ *Work packages* are the smallest units in a WBS — concrete enough to be estimated, assigned, and monitored.

Saki (咲希) "Those aren't work packages yet. They're categories. We need a **WBS** (Work Breakdown Structure — a hierarchical decomposition of total project work) to break each one down into manageable units."

→ The *WBS* organizes all project work into a tree structure. It ensures nothing is missed and nothing is duplicated.

Ren (蓮) "So you want me to turn one page into a tree diagram. Tonight."

Saki (咲希) "I want you to do it properly. Once the scope statement and WBS are approved together, they become the **scope baseline** (the approved version of the scope statement and WBS) — the reference point for every future decision."

→ The *scope baseline* locks in what was agreed. Any change after this point must go through formal evaluation.

Ren (蓮) "Wait — that email from Kudo's assistant. Another feature? We haven't even baselined yet and scope is already creeping."

Saki (咲希) "Then let's finish this tonight. I'll help you restructure it. It's just... process."

She pulls her chair closer to the whiteboard. Ren isn't sure "just process" explains why she's still here at 8 PM on a Thursday.

Scope Statement

DEFINITION A detailed description of the project scope including deliverables, boundaries, exclusions, constraints, and acceptance criteria.

COMPONENTS Project objectives · Deliverables list · Exclusions · Constraints · Assumptions

RELATED TERMS deliverable, scope baseline, project

EXAMPLE Ren's draft listed features but omitted exclusions and acceptance criteria — exactly what Saki flagged. A complete scope statement prevents "I assumed that was included" arguments later.

WBS (Work Breakdown Structure)

DEFINITION A hierarchical decomposition of total project work into smaller, manageable components.

COMPONENTS Top level (project) · Major deliverables · Sub-deliverables · Work packages

RELATED TERMS work package, scope statement, deliverable

EXAMPLE Saki pushed Ren to break "XR demo module" into sub-components: scene rendering, interaction layer, content loader. Each branch ends in a work package that one person can own.

Work Package

DEFINITION The lowest level of the WBS, representing a manageable unit of work that can be estimated, scheduled, and assigned.

COMPONENTS Defined scope · Estimated effort · Assigned owner · Measurable completion criteria

RELATED TERMS WBS, deliverable, milestone

EXAMPLE "Build interaction layer for XR demo" is a work package — small enough to assign to a developer, large enough to produce a testable output.

Scope Baseline

DEFINITION The approved version of the scope statement and WBS, used as a reference point for measuring project performance and managing changes.

COMPONENTS Approved scope statement · Approved WBS · WBS dictionary

RELATED TERMS scope statement, WBS, deliverable

EXAMPLE Once Ren and Saki finalize the scope statement and WBS together, that combination becomes the scope baseline — the line against which every future "Can we just add..." gets measured.

Review Corner

1 The Charter Check

Ren (蓮) "Saki, Director Kudo's new feature — was that in the original **project charter**?"

Saki (咲希) "No. The charter authorized a single-platform XR build. Retail expansion is a separate initiative. That's exactly why we baseline."

→ *Project charter & business case* (Unit 4): The charter defines the project's authorized boundaries. Anything outside it requires formal justification.

2 The Hidden Stakeholder

Ren (蓮) "I just realized — we never added VP Yamamoto to the **stakeholder register**. And now she's got **requirements** for a retail pilot."

Saki (咲希) "Update the register immediately. Assess her **influence** and **engagement level**. A **stakeholder** you don't track is a risk you can't manage."

→ *Stakeholder identification & analysis* (Units 3, 5): The stakeholder register is a living document. New stakeholders can emerge at any time — especially when senior leaders make introductions.